

notice a pattern here.” If slide #3 goes on to cite reasons for the trend, say: “*Nevertheless*, reasons for the trend are easily identified.”

If you wanted to be boring, you could have said:

#1: “Here are the sales figures for this year.”

#2: “The trend for those figures is shown on this slide.”

#3: “The reasons for the trend are as follows.”

On a different note (see how we used a connecting phrase here?), there’s the importance of linking to the previous slides or to something you said earlier. This drastically improves recall, that is, it increases how much they’ll take home. (Remember the taking-home thing? And now that we’ve said it again, can you forget it?)

But we should caution you against doing it for the sake of it: don’t just say “Earlier we spoke about sales for 2004. Now we’ll look at sales for 2006.” Instead, put forth something like this: “At this point—2005—we’re about to speak about 2006; recall what we said about sales in 2004, and you’ll see that...” This example also leads to the next point about flow—that your speech should “anticipate” future slides, future topics.

Finally, there should be a summary at the end—a rule very obvious; very easy to state; very easy to follow; very easy to forget.

2.3.6 Say

We’d like to bring to your attention a little gem from wise men of yore. It goes like this:

- Say what you’re going to say;
- Say it;
- Say what you said.

Gems should be left untouched and kept encased, opened only occasionally to show. We’ve opened it and shown you.